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MODEL RELEASES & RESEARCH — 17 stories

1 Show HN: Is AI Dumber Today? An index of AI model experience from user's opinion

The idea that GPUs are poorly suited for agentic workflows may be a misconception, according to French startup Kog.

HackerNews · 90% · HN 16

<https://isaidumber.today/>

2 Show HN: Needle2: 14MB agentic LLM for phones, wearables, smart home and robots

Hey HN, Henry from Cactus here! We previously released Cactus Needle, a 14MB agentic LLM for tool call, device use, and structured extraction for phones, wearables, smart homes, small robots and microcontrollers. We got really great feedback here, and have now incorporated the...

HackerNews · 60% · HN 530

<https://cactuscompute.com/needle>

3 Anthropic shares more details about how Claude's new watermarks will work

How will the watermarking actually work? Can it be hidden with editing? And how does this affect code?

TechCrunch AI · 50%

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/08/15/anthropic-shares-more-details-about-how-claude-s-new-w...>

4 Google will now allow users to remove visible watermark from its AI generations

Turning off this setting won't affect invisible benchmarks used to identify an AI generated file.

TechCrunch AI · 50%

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/08/14/google-will-now-allow-users-to-remove-visible-waterma...>

5 Does Mark Zuckerberg really believe AI is 'for everyone'?

Meta released Glimmer this week, an open-weight AI model anyone can download and run on their own hardware — a contrast to Muse Spark, the company's more powerful model that stays locked behind its own APIs. The release landed alongside a letter from Mark Zuckerberg arguing AI...

TechCrunch AI · 50%

<https://techcrunch.com/video/does-mark-zuckerberg-really-believe-ai-is-for-everyone/>

6 Meta's 'open' AI, and a \$250M deal gone very wrong

Meta released Glimmer this week, an open-weight AI model anyone can download and run on their own hardware — a contrast to Muse Spark, the company's more powerful model that stays locked behind its own APIs. The release landed alongside a letter from Mark Zuckerberg arguing AI...

TechCrunch AI · 50%

<https://techcrunch.com/podcast/metas-open-ai-and-a-250m-deal-gone-very-wrong/>

7 Writer introduces new AI model and upgraded harness to contain token costs

Built as a post-training variation on Z.ai's open source model GLM-5.2, Writer says the new system should provide deployment-ready capabilities at a much lower price.

TechCrunch AI · 50%

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/08/13/writer-introduces-new-ai-model-and-upgraded-harness-t...>

8 OpenAI introduces 'Ultrafast,' a new mode that makes GPT-5.6 Sol work at 14x the speed

OpenAI is launching a preview of a sped up version of its latest, most powerful model, in an effort to court enterprise users.

TechCrunch AI · 50%

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/08/13/openai-introduces-ultrafast-a-new-mode-that-makes-gpt...>

9 Anthropic set AI agents loose on the same task. They started a turf war.

Anthropic researchers found AI agents can clash, collude, and coordinate in unexpected ways, raising new questions about whether today's safety tests capture the risks of multi-agent systems.

TechCrunch AI · 50%

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/08/13/anthropic-set-ai-agents-loose-on-the-same-task-they-s...>

10 Microsoft kills off unsuccessful AI features while merging its separate Copilot apps

Microsoft is simplifying Copilot by combining its consumer and business apps, and dropping AI-generated podcasts, Group Chats, Deep Research, and its Mico character.

TechCrunch AI · 50%

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/08/13/microsoft-kills-off-unsuccessful-ai-features-while-me...>

11 Some Claude users are mad that Anthropic's new watermarks will catch them using it at their jobs, classes

Is Anthropic's new watermarking system a travesty? Some have taken to social media to complain that it is.

TechCrunch AI · 50%

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/08/12/some-claude-users-are-mad-that-anthropics-new-waterma...>

12 Claude Code costs up to \$200 a month. Goose does the same thing for free.

The artificial intelligence coding revolution comes with a catch: it's expensive. Claude Code , Anthropic's terminal-based AI agent that can write, debug, and deploy code autonomously, has captured the imagination of software developers worldwide. But its pricing â ranging...

VentureBeat AI · 50%

<https://venturebeat.com/infrastructure/claude-code-costs-up-to-usd200-a-month-goose-doe...>

STRATEGIC & BUSINESS — 9 stories**13 OpenAI is losing its second executive this week**

Another OpenAI executive is departing. Denise Dresser, who joined OpenAI as its chief revenue officer in December after serving as CEO of Slack, will be leaving in the "coming weeks" to "pursue other opportunities," she said in a team note posted to LinkedIn. Dali Rajic,...

The Verge AI · 80%

<https://www.theverge.com/ai-artificial-intelligence/979815/openai-denise-dresser-leavin...>

14 Databricks wanted to raise \$1B, investors wanted \$15B. It settled on \$5B at a \$190B valuation.

AI is expensive, Ali Ghodsi tells TechCrunch. With so many investors wanting into his latest round, he said yes to more than planned.

TechCrunch AI · 50%

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/08/13/databricks-wanted-to-raise-1b-investors-wanted-15b-it...>

15 IBM partners with OpenAI to bolster enterprise AI push

IBM plans to train and certify tens of thousands of consultants on OpenAI's technologies as part of this deal.

TechCrunch AI · 50%

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/08/13/ibm-partners-with-openai-to-bolster-enterprise-ai-push/>

16 Amazon will train on Twitch streamers' content by default, unless they opt out

"If this was opt-in, nobody would opt in," Twitch CPO Mike Minton said on a livestream responding to user feedback. "That's honestly the answer."

TechCrunch AI · 50%

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/08/12/amazon-will-train-on-twitch-streamers-content-by-defa...>

17 AI coding startup Cognition reportedly already in talks to raise at \$40B valuation

Cognition may be looking to raise another mega round just a few months after raising \$1 billion at a \$26 billion valuation.

TechCrunch AI · 50%

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/08/12/ai-coding-startup-cognition-reportedly-already-in-tal...>

18 Railway secures \$100 million to challenge AWS with AI-native cloud infrastructure

Railway , a San Francisco-based cloud platform that has quietly amassed two million developers without spending a dollar on marketing, announced Thursday that it raised \$100 million in a Series B funding round, as surging demand for artificial intelligence applications exposes...

VentureBeat AI · 50%

<https://venturebeat.com/infrastructure/railway-secures-usd100-million-to-challenge-aws-...>

19 Listen Labs raises \$69M after viral billboard hiring stunt to scale AI customer interviews

Alfred Wahlforss was running out of options. His startup, Listen Labs , needed to hire over 100 engineers, but competing against Mark Zuckerberg's \$100 million offers seemed impossible. So he spent \$5,000 â a fifth of his marketing budget â on a billboard in San Francisco...

VentureBeat AI · 50%

<https://venturebeat.com/technology/listen-labs-raises-usd69m-after-viral-billboard-hiri...>

20 Salesforce rolls out new Slackbot AI agent as it battles Microsoft and Google in workplace AI

Salesforce on Tuesday launched an entirely rebuilt version of Slackbot , the company's workplace assistant, transforming it from a simple notification tool into what executives describe as a fully powered AI agent capable of searching enterprise data, drafting documents, and...

VentureBeat AI · 50%

<https://venturebeat.com/technology/salesforce-rolls-out-new-slackbot-ai-agent-as-it-bat...>

21 Microsoft's Clippy-like Mico character is no longer the face of Copilot

Microsoft Copilot will no longer show its emotive yellow blob, Mico, when you use the chatbot's voice mode. In a support page, Microsoft says it's going to move Mico to its Learn Live platform, where the avatar will have "more to react to," as reported earlier by GeekWire. Mico...

The Verge AI · 50%

<https://www.theverge.com/tech/979871/microsoft-copilot-mico-retired>

SAFETY & REGULATION — 1 story**22 Rogue AI aren't science fiction anymore**

This is The Stepback, a weekly newsletter breaking down one essential story from the tech world. For more on AI safety, follow Robert Hart. The Stepback arrives in our subscribers' inboxes at 8AM ET. Opt in for The Stepback here. How it started It all started in July, when one...

The Verge AI · 50%

<https://www.theverge.com/column/980337/rogue-ai-science-fiction-openai>

TOOLS & ENGINEERING — 4 stories**23 Show HN: Ballet - Workflow automation that writes integrations against any API**

HackerNews · 50% · HN 36

<https://www.ballet.dev/>

24 Show HN: Mocktail - Free, open-source mock API server with a built-in dashboard

Hi HN, I built the first version of Mocktail years ago. I recently came back to the project, and after a pretty substantial rebuild, v4 is now out. Mocktail is a free and open-source, self-hosted mock API server with a built-in dashboard and database, packaged as a single ~25 MB...

HackerNews · 50% · HN 22

<https://getmocktail.com/>

25 Show HN: I evaluated file, vector, graph and RL based memory frameworks

HackerNews · 50% · HN 13

<https://www.pinglin.tw/blog/the-shapes-of-agent-memory>

26 Woman claims her stepfather used Grok to transform childhood photo into explicit imagery

The woman claimed that AI tools are "taking everyday life and turning it into child sexual abuse."

TechCrunch AI · 50%

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/08/15/woman-claims-her-stepfather-used-grok-to-transform-ch...>

GENERAL AI NEWS — 11 stories

27 Show HN: Deltix - AI Driven Testing

When we set out to talk to kids about artificial intelligence, we thought we knew what we'd hear. We expected some to tell us they were using it to cheat a little, the way Millennials and Gen Xers opened up CliffsNotes or programmed formulas into their TI-82s, and others to...

HackerNews · 90% · HN 51

<https://app.deltix.ai>

28 Show HN: Voice driven murder mystery, Interview AI suspects with your voice

Hey HN! I'm excited to show off this really fun project I put together. I originally built this project 2-3 years ago, AI was already booming at the time, however voice AI agents were still very early. I loved my proof of concept at the time, but wasn't quite happy with it. I...

HackerNews · 60% · HN 214

<https://www.whodunnitai.com/>

29 Show HN: ThoughtDAG - An editable context graph for LLM conversations

HackerNews · 60% · HN 128

<https://chenxiachan.github.io/thoughtdag/>

30 Show HN: Laptop is the last place your secrets are still in plaintext

HackerNews · 50% · HN 50

<https://github.com/jitpass/jit>

31 Show HN: Every MUNI, BART and Caltrain in SF on a Live Map

HackerNews · 50% · HN 11

<https://github.com/UtpalJayNadiger/wheres-my-muni>

32 Show HN: Self-hosted monitoring for AI recommendations (MIT License)

HackerNews · 50% · HN 8

<https://lettertrace.com>

33 Show HN: A pre-execution guard that stops AI agents running destructive commands

HackerNews · 50% · HN 4

<https://github.com/vandith1/agent-guard>

34 Show HN: Who is using AI? A daily tracker, 1,600+ city heatmap, DOI dataset

HackerNews · 50% · HN 2

<https://whoisusingai.com/tracker>

35 The Download: kids' thoughts on AI, and female clones of male mice

This is today's edition of The Download, our weekday newsletter that provides a daily dose of what's going on in the world of technology. How kids feel about AI, in their own words —Jen Swetozoff and Keeley McNamara, the founding editors of Anyway, an independent print magazine...

MIT Tech Review · 50%

<https://www.technologyreview.com/2026/08/13/1141896/the-download-kids-thoughts-on-ai-fe...>

36 Have a laugh at AI's expense by roleplaying as a chatbot

Your AI Slop Bores Me is brilliant in its simplicity. There are two tabs: human and LARP as an AI. On one side you enter a request. On the other, you submit an answer. But the important thing is that there's a human on both sides of the equation. Prompts can request a response...

The Verge AI · 50%

<https://www.theverge.com/entertainment/980502/roleplay-as-an-ai-chatbot>

37 I looked inside an AI generated movie, and the best parts were all human

Imagine a trio of bumbling, English lads who fantasize about becoming megastars while knocking back a few pints in a grimy pub somewhere in London. Picture the guys chortling and trying to one-up each other's idealized visions of the future with a series of increasingly glitzy...

The Verge AI · 50%

<https://www.theverge.com/entertainment/977994/higgsfield-ai-cully-hill-boys-black-list>